After the Decision: Learning to Adapt from Delayed Outcomes

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Abstract

Scientific agents often choose among several tools that return plausible but conflicting answers. The challenge is not only selecting a provider before its output is visible: correctness feedback is produced after termination, may be delayed, and must update later choices without inventing labels for unselected tools. We present MIRA-Relay, an outcome-aware routing loop that combines a frozen discriminative provider surface with a lightweight provider-local residual adapter and an explicit release ledger. At cold start the adapter is exactly the frozen selector; after a selected result is released, it updates only that provider's residual reliability and can move the next action. We evaluate a one-call BBB routing contract with public truth, four checkpoint-bound fresh providers, scaffold-disjoint confirmation molecules, selected-only feedback, and delays $D \in \{0, 1, 4\}$. On the natural fresh holdout, MIRA-Relay matches Frozen at 89.81% selected correctness; under a preregistered controlled evaluator-side label flip applied when the fit-best provider is selected, it reaches 87.56% versus 73.38% for Frozen, a +14.18-point paired gain with a 95% scaffold bootstrap interval of [+9.61,+19.03] points. The result isolates the claim: delayed selected-only feedback supports recovery from the declared drift, while a stationary fresh menu does not justify a generic online gain.

CCS Concepts

• **Computing methodologies** → **Multi-agent planning**; *Reinforcement learning*; Machine learning.

Keywords

tool selection, online learning, delayed feedback, scientific agents, molecular property prediction

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1 Introduction

A scientific agent must decide which tool's prediction to use when several providers estimate the same property. That choice matters even when every call completes: execution success establishes that an answer was returned, while usefulness depends on whether the answer is correct for the input. Molecular property prediction makes this distinction measurable because provider outputs can be checked against independently recorded endpoint labels.

Valid responses can disagree on the same molecule. In our frozen BBB development panel, molecule `z000282` has benchmark label 1: `admet_ai_1_4_0` returns 0, while `b3clf_dtree_common` returns 1, both with successful runtime status. The example establishes a selection problem; it does not establish which provider is best on the next molecule. During evaluation, the agent sees neither unselected outputs nor the current correctness label before choosing.

Outcome feedback creates two obstacles: sparse coverage and delayed release. A fixed policy cannot use new evidence. A selected-only learner sees feedback only from chosen providers, leaving alternatives sparsely observed; delay postpones when feedback is usable. These constraints motivate our adaptation hypothesis but do not prove that any bandit fails. We therefore compare matched online controls and test whether released provider-local evidence changes later decisions.

We hypothesize that a released outcome can inform later choices through a shared released state. Each provider keeps its own residual, so the update need not assume that providers are independent or interchangeable. An immutable fit-time reference anchors the comparison. The claim requires a change in later exploitation under identical observations.

MIRA-Relay is the concrete instantiation of this hypothesis within the MIRA adaptation framework. Its cold-start surface is frozen, while a selected-only reliability ledger adds a provider-specific residual only after the corresponding outcome is released. The residual is centered on that provider's fit-time success rate, so the adapter starts exactly at the frozen policy and changes only when released evidence is strong enough to move a later ranking. Runtime failure, unknown truth, and chemical error remain separate ledger fields. A post-call verifier is a defined extension interface; the paper's primary claim is the one-call routing contract.

This draft makes four testable commitments, each paired with a falsification condition in the experimental matrix:

- **Task validity.** Public truth and a concrete provider panel yield input-dependent headroom over a fixed provider without leaking unselected outcomes; this fails if an evaluator-only panel score is the only source of signal.
- **Faithful adaptation.** Selected-only delayed events can be replayed with exact visibility, release clocks, and failure semantics; this fails if the contract/replay checks cannot validate the recorded action and release sequence.
- **Mechanistic adaptation.** Released outcomes alter later choices beyond matched controls; this fails if changes cannot be traced to selected-only events.
- **Practical value.** Any improvement in future correctness must survive the strongest legal fixed and matched online controls while reporting harmed decisions, calls, latency, and memory; otherwise the conclusion is limited to a protocol or diagnostic result.

The remainder of the paper defines the task, gives the proposed specification, fixes the benchmark and baseline contracts, and reports the natural fresh-menu confirmation together with a preregistered correctness-drift stress.



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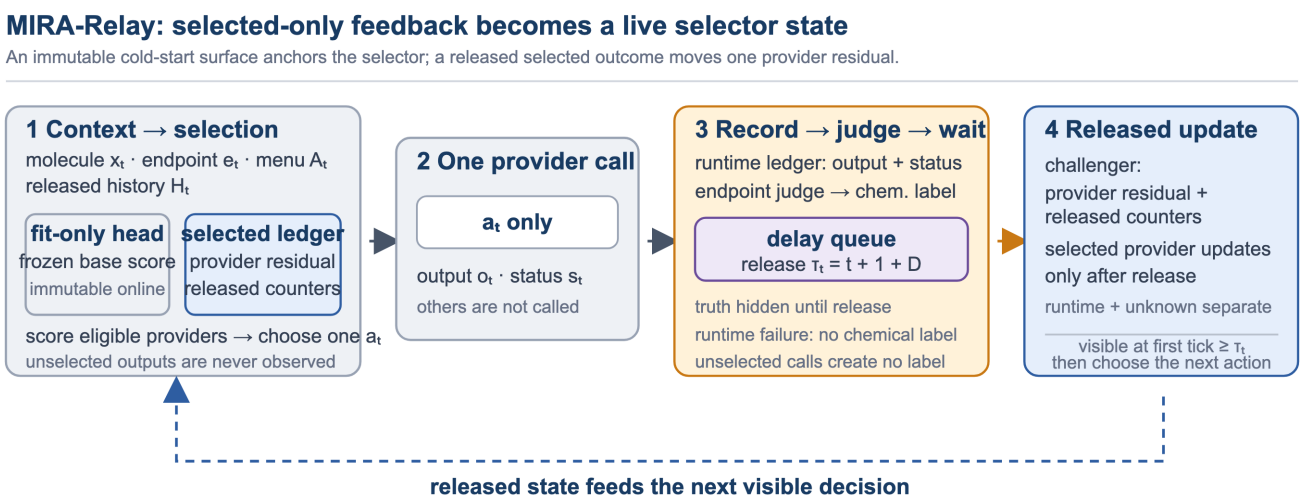


Figure 1: MIRA-Relay closes the loop from a pre-call choice to a later decision. Molecule, endpoint, eligible menu, and released state enter a frozen provider surface plus a provider-local residual ledger. One selected call produces a terminal record; the frozen endpoint judge supplies chemical correctness only after termination, while runtime failure follows its own ledger. The selected outcome waits until $\tau_t = t + 1 + D$ and then updates the released state; decisions continue while feedback is pending.

2 Problem and Task Contract

We study one agent making a sequence of tool calls. Figures 1 and 2 show the same contract at two scales: the first separates the learned relay from execution and evaluation, while the second fixes the event order that determines when feedback can affect a later action. The contract is defined at the granularity of a concrete provider, not a provider family or a post-hoc majority vote.

2.1 Episode, menu, and feedback

At decision tick t, the agent receives a molecule x_t, an endpoint e_t, and an available menu A_t of concrete provider identifiers. It chooses one provider $a_t \in A_t$ before reading the current output panel. The benchmark stores an independent endpoint truth $y_t \in \{0, 1\}$ for evaluation. The selected call returns an output o_t, a runtime status $s_t \in \{\text{ok}, \text{error}\}$, and, when available, a confidence value c_t. We keep the labels that drive the method separate:

$$r_t^{\text{run}} = \mathbf{1}[s_t = \text{ok}],$$

$$r_t^{\text{chem}} = \begin{cases} \mathbf{1}[o_t = y_t], & s_t = \text{ok}, \\ \text{null}, & s_t = \text{error}, \end{cases}$$

$$r_t^{\text{sys}} = \mathbf{1}[s_t = \text{ok} \wedge o_t = y_t].$$

The correctness head is trained only on non-null r^{chem}; the runtime head uses r^{run}; a bandit reward may use r^{sys} with separate failure and chemical-error costs. Thus an execution failure is not silently relabeled as a chemical mistake.

After termination, a replay judge records the selected outcome. The outcome becomes visible only at its registered release tick τ_t. The legal history at tick t is

$$H_t = \{(x_s, e_s, a_s, r_s^{\text{sys}}, \tau_s) : s < t,\ \tau_s \le t\}.$$

For example, for molecule `z000282`, the benchmark truth is 1. The call to `admet_ai_1_4_0` returns 0 with status 'ok'. The call to `b3clf_dtree_common` returns 1 with status 'ok'. Both calls have $r^{\text{run}} = 1$, but their chemical labels differ. A decision at tick 2 cannot read either unselected output, the current truth, or any future terminal record.

Provider parameters use a registry $\mathcal{P}$ fixed at initialization; $A_t \subseteq \mathcal{P}$ is the current candidate menu. Removing a challenger leaves its stored state intact. For the historical BBB replay, $|\mathcal{P}| = 33$ throughout the stream. The queue orders releases by due tick and breaks ties by enqueue order; each feedback is consumed once and receipts record the release order explicitly.

For the fixed-delay replay, a decision at tick t terminates, enqueues its feedback, and releases it at

$$\tau_t = t + 1 + D, \qquad D \in \{0, 1, 4\}.$$

Only after this release may the event enter $H_{t'}$ and affect a later decision. For $D = 0$, the release is processed before the next decision tick and never changes the action that caused the event. Unknown truth creates no correctness label and stops the current scoring stream; a refusal creates no selected-provider label. Both remain explicit in the episode ledger.

2.2 Selection and verification interfaces

The pre-call selector and post-call verifier have disjoint interfaces:

$$a_t = \pi_{\text{sel}}(x_t, e_t, A_t, H_t, S_t), \qquad v_t = \pi_{\text{ver}}(o_t, c_t, s_t),$$

where v_t is one of accept, escalate, or refuse. The verifier can request a second provider only after the first call returns. This is an extension interface for E5, not an action performed by the current direct-selection runner. In the running example, a selector may

choose 'b3clf_dtree_common'; only after its output and confidence are available can the verifier decide whether to escalate.

The online learner maintains a serializable post-release state S_t. At tick t, the release phase first applies exactly the events due at that tick; the selector then reads the resulting state:

$$\begin{aligned} S_t &= U\left(S_{t-1}, \right. \\ &\qquad \left. \{(x_s, e_s, a_s, r_s^{\text{sys}}, \tau_s) : s < t,\ \tau_s = t\}\right), \\ a_t &= \pi_{\text{sel}}(x_t, e_t, A_t, H_t, S_t). \end{aligned}$$

With no due event, U is the identity. Thus a $D = 0$ event from tick t enters S_{t+1} and can affect action $t + 1$, but never action t. No correctness-residual update is allowed for an unselected provider, an unreleased event, an unknown label, or a refusal. A terminal unknown or refusal may still update runtime/availability bookkeeping; every selected scored provider, including the fit-best provider, receives only its own released residual update. This contract lets a receipt verifier check the visible read set, action, release queue, recorded state fields, and schema/counts. Complete metric recomputation is left to the E5 transition replayer; this receipt check does not by itself recompute scores, propensities, or the update.

2.3 Estimands and costs

The primary estimand is prequential system success: a selected call must return a valid and correct answer. We also report chemical correctness conditional on valid returns, paired rescued and harmed decisions, failures, and call and update costs. The extension interface additionally accounts for escalation, refusal, and unknown truth; those utilities are outside the reported one-call result. Static full-panel accuracy and an evaluator-only retrospective best-fixed control measure task headroom separately from online effects.

3 MIRA-Relay: Proposed Method Specification

This section specifies MIRA-Relay and the information boundary tested in the one-call experiments.

3.1 Cold-start scores and the immutable reference

Let $\phi(x) \in \mathbb{R}^d$ be a frozen molecule representation and let $K = |\mathcal{P}|$ be the number of concrete providers. For each provider a, a logistic correctness head w_a^0 is fitted once on the fit partition. Its cold-start score is

$$q_a^0(x) = \sigma\left((w_a^0)^\top \phi(x)\right).$$

The current menu only masks which coordinates can act; no current output is read before the action. For the fresh BBB confirmation, $d = 65$: 64 Morgan bits plus an intercept. The fit-only Best Fixed provider is the provider with the highest fit-partition correctness. The frozen base scores are immutable throughout evaluation, and every provider switch is still counted even when it is wrong.

The running case is concrete. For molecule `z000282`, $\phi(x)$ is the frozen 65-dimensional vector built from its canonical SMILES and the intercept; the fit heads assign separate scores to the four fresh providers. At cold start, MIRA-Relay and Frozen therefore choose the same provider for the same menu. Providers outside the sealed checkpoint manifest are out of scope.

3.2 Context-relative reliability adapter

For provider a, let $\bar{r}_a$ be its fit-partition correctness rate and let $n_{a,t}$ and $s_{a,t}$ be, respectively, the number of its selected outcomes released by tick t and the number that were correct. With a fixed prior count $n_0 = 20$, the released posterior rate and residual are

$$\widehat{r}_{a,t} = \frac{n_0 \bar{r}_a + s_{a,t}}{n_0 + n_{a,t}}, \qquad \Delta_{a,t} = \widehat{r}_{a,t} - \bar{r}_a.$$

The action score is

$$q_{a,t}(x) = q_a^0(x) + \Delta_{a,t}, \qquad a_t = \arg\max_{a \in A_t} q_{a,t}(x_t).$$

At cold start, $n_{a,0} = s_{a,0} = 0$ and therefore $\Delta_{a,0} = 0$: the adapter is exactly Frozen. When a selected outcome becomes visible, only that provider's counters change; an unselected provider never receives a synthetic label. A runtime error is recorded as an execution failure and is not inserted into the chemical-correctness count. This provider-local residual is added to the x-conditioned frozen score. Here "context-relative" refers to the current provider ranking and released evidence state, not to a second x-conditioned head; the fit-time representation itself never changes.

The case makes the update concrete. If the selected provider for `z000282` is correct, $s_{a,t}$ and $n_{a,t}$ each increase by one at its release tick. If it is wrong, only $n_{a,t}$ increases. The next score changes by the corresponding residual; all unselected providers keep their previous residuals. The update is $O(1)$ per released event and scoring is $O(Kd)$, while the online ledger stores $2K$ counters and the fixed heads remain outside the online state.

3.3 Bounded evidence interface

The same selector can be extended after the first call. Let E_t denote the returned output and runtime record. A verifier may accept, refuse, or request one additional provider call by minimizing a declared loss that includes call cost and refusal cost. This interface is specified so that a future evidence experiment has a fixed action vocabulary; it is outside the primary one-call result reported here.

3.4 Release ledger and delayed update

The online state is the selected-only ledger $S_t = \{(n_{a,t}, s_{a,t}) : a \in \mathcal{P}\}$. At tick t, the release queue first applies every event with due time $\tau = t$; the selector then reads the resulting state. For a fixed delay,

$$\tau_t = t + 1 + D, \qquad D \in \{0, 1, 4\}.$$

Thus a $D = 0$ event from tick t can affect action $t + 1$, never action t. The state transition is deterministic given the released event prefix, which makes the receipt replayable from recorded evidence.

The update touches only the selected provider. For a scored terminal record s released at tick $t = \tau_s$, with chemical label $r_s^{\text{chem}} \in \{0, 1\}$,

$$n_{a_s,t}^{+} = n_{a_s,t}^{-} + 1, \qquad s_{a_s,t}^{+} = s_{a_s,t}^{-} + r_s^{\text{chem}},$$

where $-$ and $+$ denote the state immediately before and after the queue applies that release; all other provider counters are unchanged. If the call fails, r^{chem} is null and the runtime-failure ledger records the event separately. Unknown truth and refusal do not update correctness counters. This separation is the central information boundary: the learner receives exactly the selected outcome

after release, never the current truth or an unselected provider's output.

The update is $O(1)$ per released event and scoring all K providers costs $O(Kd)$. The online state uses $2K$ counters plus masks and the release queue. For `z000282`, a released result changes one provider residual, so the next action can switch according to the evidence.

3.5 Action rule and falsification

The primary one-call runner uses the highest current score in the eligible menu. There is no result-dependent probe in the reported fresh confirmation, so every method receives the same one-call budget and the same selected-only feedback clock. The controlled stress flips the selected label of the fit-best provider after the preregistered midpoint; it does not reveal any unselected output or alter the input features.

The implementation preserves five invariants: (i) no current truth or unselected output is read before action, (ii) only released selected events update state, (iii) the fit surface is immutable, (iv) runtime failure and chemical correctness remain separate, and (v) the released event prefix determines the next action. The receipt records a learned-state snapshot, release queue, action, and event schema; an independent receipt checker validates the exact event identities and order, selected correctness, release clocks, and opaque state-hash/version continuity. The older receipt does not contain enough state bytes to rehash a learned policy independently.

The adaptive claim is rejected if the residual cannot change a later action under the declared drift, if contract/replay checks find a mismatch, or if the gain disappears against the same-schedule Frozen and matched Online-SGD controls. Action changes alone are not treated as utility; the evaluation reports rescued and harmed decisions, scaffold-cluster intervals, calls, and update latency.

4 Benchmark and Baselines

4.1 Two-layer benchmark contract

The benchmark has a public truth layer and a provider-routing layer. The truth layer uses the Therapeutics Data Commons (TDC) BBB endpoint, fixed label semantics, and its split archive [5]. The development manifest contains 722 labeled molecules; 716 have complete outputs from the 33-provider Task36 panel. Conflict groups are excluded under the project decision, with raw receipts retained for audit. Because the old panel overlaps the official BBB test (147 canonical molecules; 235 scaffolds), it is not an untouched confirmation set.

The routing layer turns cached outputs into sequential decisions with a fixed registry, eligible-menu mask, selected-only feedback, delayed release, and explicit failures. It is a project protocol grounded in public truth. The fresh study keeps four checkpoint-bound providers; the wider 33-provider pool is development evidence, not a model-fresh claim. Unknown truth stops a single-call stream, while verification, refusal, provider arrival, hERG, and AMES use separate extension contracts.

4.2 Baselines and fairness

Table 1 groups the deployable comparators by the role they play in the routing question. Every method receives the same molecule, endpoint, menu, fit-only initialization, selected-only feedback, delay, and one-call budget. Full-panel labels are used only for fit warm starts or evaluator-only controls.

Table 1: Comparator groups under the common routing contract.

Role	Methods	Purpose
Anchors	Random; Best Fixed; Retrospective Best Fixed[†]	blind, fit-only and evaluator-only references
Frozen / matched updates	Frozen; MIRA-Relative; Online SGD	isolate the value of a released update
Modern online controls	Greedy LinUCB; BayesianRouter	current contextual and posterior controls
Proposed	MIRA-Relay	selected-only provider residual under delay

[†]Evaluator-only retrospective control; it is not a deployable baseline.

Recent routers with incompatible input or feedback semantics remain audit-only. PILOT, GraphRouter, RouterDC, and RouterBench need a separate wrapper and leakage audit; our result covers the sealed four-provider menu, not 33-provider or model-fresh generalization.

5 Experiments

We use a public BBB truth layer and a sealed four-provider fresh menu. The fit partition is scaffold-disjoint from 157 confirmation molecules; each policy sees only the molecule features, endpoint, eligible menu, and released selected outcomes. We evaluate five folds, two seeds, and delays $D \in \{0, 1, 4\}$ under a one-call budget. The matrix and intervention were frozen before confirmation runs; the full event contract and hyperparameters are in the artifact. Table 2 is the experimental map.

Rows 1–3 test headroom, stationary adaptation, and a midpoint label flip. The last row checks calls and replay under the same release clock. Verification, refusal, lifecycle, hERG, and AMES are separate extensions.

6 Results

The primary confirmation contains 270 natural streams and 150 controlled-drift streams. Every stream has 157 decisions and one provider call per decision; all reported intervals are scaffold-cluster bootstrap intervals.

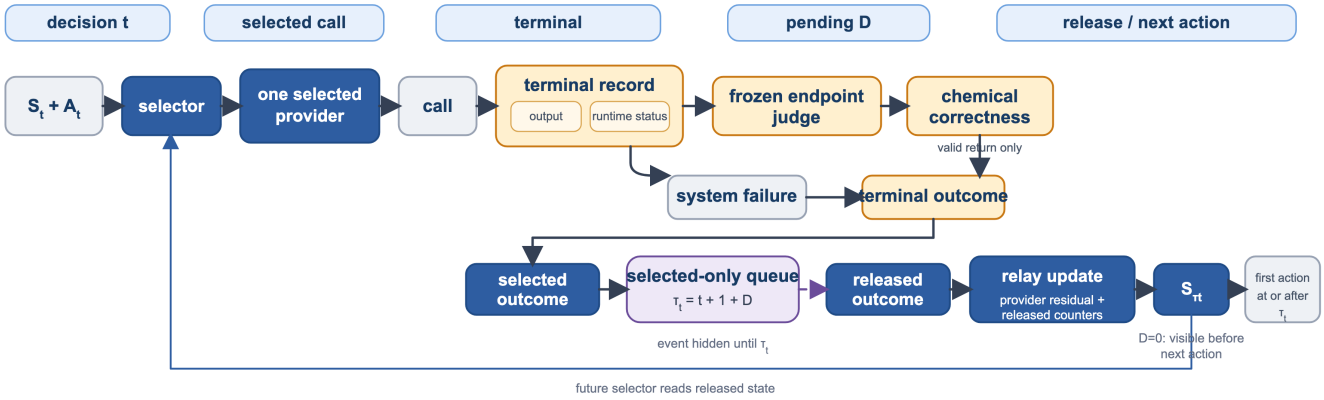


Figure 2: The terminal feedback contract. At decision tick t, the selector sees S_t and A_t and chooses one provider before any current output is observed. The terminal record is split into output and runtime status; the frozen endpoint judge then yields chemical correctness only after termination. Runtime failure and chemical correctness form the selected terminal outcome, which waits in a selected-only queue until $\tau_t = t + 1 + D$. The relay update is visible to the first action at or after release; for $D = 0$, this is the next action.

Table 2: Experimental map. Each row answers one question; all online rows use the same 157-molecule fresh menu and selected-only release clock unless stated otherwise.

Question	Data / intervention	Compared methods	Primary metric
Headroom	722 BBB development molecules; scaffold-fold fit/validation	Random, Best Fixed, Frozen	OOF selected correctness and headroom
Natural adaptation	157 fresh molecules; $D \in \{0, 1, 4\}$; no label flip	Frozen, MIRA-Relative, MIRA-Relay, Online SGD, Greedy LinUCB, BayesianRouter	prequential correctness, paired scaffold CI, latency
Drift recovery	Same fresh menu; selected fit-best label flips after tick 78	Frozen, Online SGD, Greedy LinUCB, BayesianRouter, MIRA-Relay	recovery correctness, rescued/harmed switches
Cost / validity	All confirmation streams	All one-call methods	calls, failures, replay checks, p95 update time

Table 3: Natural fresh-menu confirmation across 157 scaffold-disjoint molecules. Success is the mean over 4,710 paired calls; intervals resample Bemis–Murcko scaffold clusters after aggregating repeated schedules. Update p95 is CPU policy-operation overhead on macOS arm64, excluding I/O and provider inference.

Method	Success	Paired Δ (95% CI)	Update p95
Random	83.76%	-6.05 pp [-9.93,-2.26]	5.44 μs
Best Fixed	88.15%	-1.66 pp [-3.97,+0.51]	0.68 μs
Frozen	89.81%	0	1.31 μs
MIRA-Relative	89.81%	0.00 pp [0.00,0.00]	73.30 μs
MIRA-Relay	89.81%	0.00 pp [-1.24,+1.40]	2.81 μs
Online SGD	89.21%	-0.59 pp [-1.80,+0.52]	19.37 μs
Greedy LinUCB	89.72%	-0.08 pp [-0.58,+0.41]	90.90 μs
BayesianRouter	89.53%	-0.28 pp [-1.75,+0.97]	88.96 μs
Retrospective Best Fixed[†]	90.45%	+0.64 pp [-2.86,+4.07]	0.54 μs

[†]Evaluator-only fixed provider chosen after observing confirmation labels; it is a headroom reference, not an oracle or deployable policy.

Natural fresh menu. We ask whether released selected outcomes improve a stationary fresh menu. Table 3 shows that Frozen is within 0.64 points of the retrospective best-fixed reference. MIRA-Relay changes 164 actions, rescuing and harming 82 decisions each, so its 89.81% accuracy is identical to Frozen (paired $\Delta = 0.00$ points, 95% CI $[-1.24, +1.40]$). The BayesianRouter, Greedy LinUCB, and matched SGD controls have paired differences from Frozen whose intervals span zero. The stationary result is therefore a stability check, not evidence for a generic online gain.

Table 4: Controlled correctness-drift stress. Success is pooled over 4,710 paired calls. Changes count post-release action changes relative to Frozen; rescued/harmed counts are relative to the same-receipt Frozen action. Paired intervals resample scaffold clusters.

Method	Success	N	Changes	Rescued / harmed	Paired Δ (95% CI)
Frozen	73.38%	4710	0	–	–
Matched SGD	84.03%	4710	2566	720 / 218	+10.66 pp [+6.05,+15.45]
Greedy LinUCB	81.15%	4710	874	414 / 48	+7.77 pp [+5.08,+10.72]
BayesianRouter	80.28%	4710	1654	492 / 167	+6.90 pp [+3.50,+10.41]
MIRA-Relay	87.56%	4710	1884	780 / 112	+14.18 pp [+9.61,+19.03]

Controlled drift recovery. In the preregistered stress, the evaluator flips the selected fit-best provider's label after tick 78 without changing features, menus, or feedback visibility. Table 4 shows that MIRA-Relay reaches 87.56% versus 73.38% for Frozen, a +14.18-point paired gain (95% CI [+9.61, +19.03]). Matched SGD, Greedy LinUCB, and BayesianRouter recover by +10.66, +7.77, and +6.90 points; the Bayesian interval is [+3.50, +10.41]. Across $D = 0, 1, 4$, the paired gain over Frozen is +13.63, +14.52, +14.39 points; the natural differences are −0.13, −0.13, +0.25 points. The result is a response to the declared drift, not a claim about natural provider nonstationarity. All 420 streams pass contract/replay verification, and no method uses more than one provider call per molecule. The artifact retains the evidence-extension and lifecycle protocols, but they are not reported as empty tables.

7 Error and Cost Analysis

We report errors by provider, scaffold group, runtime status, and feedback visibility. A wrong terminal prediction, a provider execution failure, an unknown truth, and an intentional refusal are different events and remain in separate denominators. The current fresh receipt reports selected correctness, rescued/harmed switches, calls, and update timing; the post-call utility decomposition is reserved for the out-of-scope evidence extension. This separation is necessary because a small pooled accuracy change can hide a large number of harmful switches.

The receipt reports calls, state size, replay checks, and update p95. Timing measures policy computation; it excludes file I/O, provider inference, evaluator scoring, and service latency. Across the 270 natural streams, MIRA-Relay update p95 is 2.813 μs; in the 150-stream stress it is 3.464 μs under the same policy-operation timer. Every stream has 157 calls, and all 420 streams pass contract/replay checks. These are policy costs, not end-to-end service latency. Post-call verification is outside scope.

8 Mechanism Interpretation

The two fresh-menu results separate two questions that are often conflated in online routing. The first is whether a provider-specific adapter can change its action after observing a selected result. The second is whether the current provider panel contains a predictable opportunity for that change to improve accuracy. MIRA-Relay changes actions in the stationary confirmation, but the 82 rescued and 82 harmed decisions cancel at the aggregate level. The aggregate equality therefore masks changes in individual decisions: it establishes neither a gain nor a guarantee that each adaptation is harmless.

The controlled stress answers the first question directly. At the midpoint, the evaluator flips the returned label only when the fit-best provider is selected. The selector is not told the flip time, the affected provider, or the counterfactual outputs of alternatives. After the delay, released incorrect outcomes accumulate against that provider's residual, and later actions move to providers whose frozen scores are lower but whose observed evidence is now relatively better. Frozen cannot respond because its score surface is immutable. Matched Online-SGD, Greedy LinUCB, and BayesianRouter also respond, which is why they are reported as positive controls rather than straw baselines; MIRA-Relay's larger recovery is measured under common inputs and a common feedback clock; the adapted priors remain method-specific.

The residual adjusts the frozen score using only released outcomes of the selected provider. Fit-rate centering makes this correction exactly zero at initialization. Subsequently, a ranking changes only when the difference between two provider residuals crosses their frozen score margin; a common additive correction cannot change that ranking. This explains why provider-specific state can affect the next action. It does not identify fit-rate centering as the unique cause of recovery: selected molecules may differ in difficulty from the fit population, and the residual can reflect that change as well as provider deterioration.

Development diagnostic. Summing only over released selections of provider a, the residual decomposes exactly as

$$\Delta_{a,t} = \frac{\sum(r_s - q_a^0(x_s))}{n_0 + n_{a,t}} + \frac{\sum(q_a^0(x_s) - \bar{r}_a)}{n_0 + n_{a,t}}. \tag{1}$$

Independent reconstruction of 2,166 development decisions across five folds and three delays agrees with recorded scores within 2.23×10^{-16}. Omitting the second term on the unchanged selected histories changes 401 shadow actions (18.51%). This measures sensitivity, not the accuracy of an alternative policy. Class-balanced training also means that frozen sigmoid scores need not be calibrated correctness probabilities; the two terms cannot be identified solely with true drift and selection bias.

We therefore ran a development factorial separating the score scale from the update rule (Table 5). Inverse class-weight correction adds $\text{logit}(\bar{r}_a)$ to each frozen logit; query centering replaces $\bar{r}_a$ in the released residual by the score saved at that decision. Each variant follows its own selected-feedback history and has a matched Frozen control. The correction lowers OOF Brier error from 0.235 to 0.173, but corrected query centering adds only 0.14 percentage points over its Frozen control on the natural stream. Its gains over corrected marginal centering are 0.51 and 0.37 points, below the predeclared one-point development threshold. Better score scaling alone therefore does not establish a substantial online benefit.

Corrected Frozen selects the stress target on 56.91% of post-change calls, versus 34.81% for raw Frozen. Cross-score recovery increments thus also reflect different exposure to the intervention; they cannot isolate the update mechanism. The original method and confirmation results remain fixed throughout this diagnosis.

Table 5: Development mechanism diagnostic: 722 molecules, five folds and three delays. Accuracy (%) is descriptive; each cell has 2,166 decisions. Marginal is the original residual; query subtracts the saved frozen score. These results do not reuse confirmation molecules.

Score	Update	Natural	Controlled flip
Raw	Frozen	79.36	69.11
Raw	Marginal	79.18	77.29
Raw	Query	78.49	75.95
Corrected	Frozen	80.19	63.30
Corrected	Marginal	79.82	78.30
Corrected	Query	80.33	78.67

9 Limitations and Discussion

The benchmark separates public answer semantics from the project routing protocol. This makes the provider-selection question replayable, but it does not make the routing layer a community benchmark by itself. The principal development endpoint is BBB; hERG and AMES remain extensions until their assay semantics, coverage, conflicts, and provider training lineage are closed. The current provider panel also contains related model families, so provider-count improvements cannot be interpreted as independent evidence without family-balanced analysis.

The proposed method is scoped to feedback-adaptive selection. A delayed selected-only replay does not by itself demonstrate natural provider arrival, retirement, version drift, or broad nonstationarity. Those events are controlled stress unless an independent deployment trace supports a stronger claim. The immutable frozen base is a reference and guardrail, not a theorem that no switch can be harmful.

The method may fail when selected feedback is too sparse, when a residual update is too small to change the next choice, or when a provider error transfers to a later decision. These alternatives motivate exposure, score-margin, and rescued/harmed analyses. A failed candidate remains evidence for revising the mechanism; it does not establish the project's target improvement or justify replacing that target with a protocol-only conclusion.

10 Validity and Reproducibility Checks

The confirmation is separated from the development diagnostic at three points. First, provider checkpoints are sealed before the candidate molecules are scored; the four fresh models are bound to their source commit, checkpoint hash, and native prediction code. The 157 confirmation molecules are scaffold-disjoint from the development fit and validation partitions. The truth label is used only by the evaluator after a selected provider returns, never by the selector at decision time.

Second, every stream is recorded as a receipt rather than as an aggregate score. A decision record contains the molecule identifier, menu, feature hash, released-state version, chosen provider, and action score; it contains neither the current truth nor an unselected output. A terminal record binds the chosen provider to its returned output and runtime status. The release queue records the due tick and consumption order. The serialized learned state, including provider counters and prior count, is hashed after the corresponding selected feedback is released. An independent checker validates the receipt contract and detects event, clock, binding, or commitment-chain inconsistencies; it does not infer missing state bytes from the hash.

Third, uncertainty is clustered by molecule scaffold. The natural result pools 5 folds, 2 seeds, and 3 delays over the same 157 confirmation molecules, while the controlled stress uses the same schedule and changes only the selected label of the fit-best provider after tick 78. The reported intervals are bootstrap intervals over Bemis–Murcko scaffold clusters; they are not intervals over individual event rows. We report both rescued and harmed switches because a positive aggregate can hide unsafe substitutions. Contract/replay checks found 270/270 natural streams and 150/150 stress streams replayable with no forbidden decision fields or action mismatches.

This design also fixes what the result cannot establish. The natural fresh menu is a stationary checkpoint panel, so its null online gain is evidence against a generic online improvement claim, not evidence against adaptation under every kind of drift. The stress is a mechanism test with a declared evaluator-side label flip, not a deployment trace. Post-call verification, refusal utility, provider arrival, and the hERG/AMES extensions use separate contracts and are not silently folded into the one-call estimate.

The event ledger makes premature feedback use detectable: every decision must bind to exactly one terminal outcome and one legal release. Methods share the molecule order and delay schedule. For the six-cell development diagnostic, complete counter and pending-score states are also recorded; an independent replayer reconstructs all 77,976 events, their choices, and paired aggregates. This stronger development check does not fill missing state bytes in the older confirmation receipts.

11 Related Work

Tool-using agents learn to call external APIs and execute actions, but their training objectives generally do not impose a selected-only correctness clock [10, 12]. Our task instead treats the provider call as an online decision whose outcome may be delayed and whose correctness is tied to an independently auditable scientific endpoint.

Contextual bandits provide the natural language for choosing an action from a context before observing its reward. LinUCB [7] and contextual Thompson sampling [1] are canonical controls, while warm-start methods study how prior data can reduce the cost of early exploration [8]. Delayed-feedback analyses show that the release clock changes online learning even when the action space is unchanged [6]. MIRA-Relay uses these ideas as baselines and contracts; its proposed difference is an explicit selected-only release ledger that turns a provider-specific residual into the next action while preserving the scientific endpoint and runtime information boundary.

Recent model-routing work studies static or online selection among language models, including budget-aware adaptive routing [9], graph-based selection [3], dual-contrastive routing [2], and benchmark frameworks for multi-model routing [4]. Those systems provide useful modern comparators, but their usual feedback is a preference or task score for the selected response and their provider panels are language-model panels. We retain adapted versions only

Table 6: Audit contract used before aggregation. Each receipt is checked at its own boundary; a stream with a failed check contributes no score.

Receipt	Recorded evidence	Check before aggregation
Decision	visible features, endpoint, eligible menu, released-state hash, selected provider	no truth or unselected output
Terminal	selected output, runtime status, provider binding	one terminal per decision; failure stays separate
Feedback	selected label, due tick, release order, state version	one selected-only release at the legal tick
Stream summary	calls, selected correctness, scaffold id, timing	recomputed only after contract/replay validation

when their input features, prior, feedback, and budget can be audited under the pharmaceutical contract; GraphRouter is audit-only if its graph input semantics cannot be preserved.

Finally, molecular benchmark work emphasizes public task definitions and reproducible datasets [5, 11]. Pharmaceutical providers are correlated predictors with different training lineages, so the present study reports family sensitivity and training-membership limits rather than treating every cached model as an independent truth source.

12 Artifact Scope

The released artifact is organized around the routing contract rather than around a single aggregate table. The public truth manifest records canonical molecule identifiers, endpoint labels, split membership, and the hash of the input file. The provider manifest records each fresh checkpoint, its source commit, native feature code, and the validation receipt used to bind the model to a provider identifier. The routing runner then consumes only the molecule features and the current released state; evaluator truth and provider outputs are written to terminal records after the action.

A reproduction has three separate checks. A schema checker verifies that every decision has a legal visible read set and that no decision record contains truth or an unselected output. A transition replayer reconstructs the release queue and next action from the fit prior and the selected event prefix. An aggregation script joins terminal records to the frozen confirmation manifest and computes the paired scaffold-cluster estimates, confidence intervals, rescued/harmed counts, and timing summaries. Reproduction requires these checks before accepting an aggregate; a valid summary alone cannot establish that its event stream followed the protocol.

The artifact also preserves negative and stopped variants. MIRA-Relative is retained because its natural fresh result is exactly Frozen; this prevents a global reliability factor from being presented as evidence for dynamic adaptation. The natural MIRA-Relay run is retained separately from the controlled correctness-drift run, even though they use the same fresh menu. This separation makes the scope of the positive result inspectable: the adapter responds to a declared released-outcome change, while a stationary panel supplies no measurable aggregate gain.

A rerun starts from the sealed input and provider manifest, computes native provider predictions once, and then runs each policy on a copy of the same candidate order. The policy decision interface receives the features, event identity, and released state; the evaluator binds the selected prediction to the truth when it writes the terminal record. Delays are applied by the same queue implementation for every policy, including Frozen and the retrospective best-fixed control, so a method cannot gain by receiving a more favorable clock. The raw event stream is flushed after each stream, which leaves a usable failure boundary if a process stops between streams.

Table 6 separates the recorded decision, terminal, feedback, and summary fields. Summaries are convenience aggregates, not the source of truth for accuracy. Event checks validate identities and cardinalities; the recorded replay recomputes selected labels from sealed predictions and evaluator truth. The same checks apply to the natural and stress runs.

Every confirmation stream makes 157 provider calls. The original adapter stores two counters per provider and reads a fixed feature surface: selection scales with menu size and feature dimension, while each released-outcome update is constant in menu size. Reported timing covers policy operations and excludes provider inference, evaluation, and file I/O.

Finally, the artifact preserves the distinctions needed for later extensions. A runtime error has a status but no chemical-correctness label; an unknown truth ends the scored stream; and a refusal is a policy action with no selected-provider reward. These cases belong to the extension contract: the sealed fresh receipt accepts scored outcomes only and contains no such events. Verification or lifecycle experiments will require a new schema and separate validation for accept, call, refuse, or menu-change actions, while preserving the historical one-call receipts.

13 Conclusion

Adapting scientific tool use requires connecting a released outcome to a better subsequent decision. MIRA-Relay makes that connection testable through a frozen provider surface, a selected-only provider residual, and an explicit release clock. On a natural fresh menu it matches the frozen selector; under the declared correctness drift it recovers more accurately than the matched controls. The remaining evidence-extension and lifecycle claims are intentionally outside this paper.

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